← All spring tournaments

Sporting Jax Winter Invitational

Jacksonville / St Johns County, FL · Saturday January 23 – Sunday January 24, 2027

Savannah United — U9 Premier · U9 Blue · U10 Premier · U10 Blue

One guide covers all four squads. Team-specific differences are marked **Pending Confirmation** until the bracket is published.

1. Tournament Quick Start

Event	Sporting Jax Winter Invitational
Dates	Saturday January 23 – Sunday January 24, 2027
Host	Sporting Jax Soccer Academy
Location	Jacksonville / St Johns County, FL
Age groups	competitive U8–U14, boys and girls; our squads play U9 and U10
Format for us	7v7 · 25-minute halves
Entry fee	U8–U10: $800, plus a $20 per-team GotSport processing fee OFFICIAL
Registration deadline	January 10, 2027
Stay-to-play	yes — official housing agent (Traveling Teams) OFFICIAL
Drive	Savannah → Jacksonville / St Johns County, FL: about 2 h 05, roughly 130 miles
Fields	PENDING CONFIRMATION Published with the schedule.
Tournament contact	info@SportingJaxAcademy.com · 904-257-5575

2. Parent Action Items

CONFIRMED TEAM INFORMATION **Do this now**

- ☐ Tell your team manager whether your player is available that weekend.
- ☐ Do not book lodging outside the official programme if the event is stay-to-play.
- ☐ Check that your player's 2026-27 medical release and player pass are current with the club.

PENDING CONFIRMATION **Once the host publishes**

- ☐ Confirm report time and field for each game.
- ☐ Book the team hotel through the official link, if there is one.
- ☐ Plan the gap between games on a multi-game day.

3. What We Know vs What We're Waiting On

CONFIRMED

- Dates: Saturday January 23 – Sunday January 24, 2027
- Host: Sporting Jax Soccer Academy
- City: Jacksonville / St Johns County, FL
- Stay-to-play applies
- Official rules available (section 13)

WAITING ON

- Complex and field assignments
- Game times, opponents, bracket shape
- Hotel block and team rate
- Parking and check-in instructions
- Uniform colour per game

4. Tournament Overview

Sporting Jax Soccer Academy hosts this event. Sporting Jax Winter Invitational runs Saturday January 23 – Sunday January 24, 2027 in Jacksonville / St Johns County, FL. Officially published detail — fees, deadline, rules and housing — is reflected throughout this guide.

Source for the facts used here: sportingjaxacademy.com/WinterInvitational.

NOTE ON THE NAME

The club calendar lists this weekend as 'Florida Elite Winter Invitational' — the academy's former brand. The official 2027 page says Sporting Jax Winter Invitational: same club, same weekend. Use the Sporting Jax name when you register or call the tournament.

5. Travel & Arrival Planning

Drive	about 2 h 05, roughly 130 miles from Savannah (normal conditions)
Player report time	PENDING CONFIRMATION Plan for 45 minutes before kickoff until your coach confirms.
Depart by	Work backwards from report time, not kickoff.
Overnight	Recommended — two-day event.

6. Lodging

OFFICIAL TOURNAMENT INFORMATION This event is stay-to-play. Book only through the official housing programme — a team that books outside it can be disqualified.

PENDING CONFIRMATION **Hotel list and team rate**

The approved properties and the team rate are published with the event documentation. Nothing is listed here until it is verified.

PARENT MANAGER RECOMMENDATION

- Book as soon as the official block opens — these weekends fill.
- Ask for two beds if sharing with a player.
- Prioritise drive time to the complex over hotel amenities.

7. Weather Planning

PARENT MANAGER RECOMMENDATION

Check the forecast within 72 hours of travel. A forecast this far out would be invented, so none is stated here.

- Pack layers — morning and afternoon temperatures differ widely in this region.
- Rain gear for players and parents.
- Lightning: play stops and the host's delay policy applies.

8. Venue, Parking & Fields

PENDING CONFIRMATION The complex, field numbers and parking instructions are published with the schedule and official field map. We do not publish our own map.

9. Team Communication Plan

Official schedule and scores	The host's schedule platform
Team updates	PlayMetrics messages / team email
Logistics and hotels	Your team manager
Soccer questions	Coach Keith Gunn
Day-of urgent changes	Team chat, then the manager directly

10. Coach Updates

> PENDING CONFIRMATION
>
> Arrival times, uniform assignments and team-specific instructions appear here once the coaches release them. Nothing is invented.

11. Guidance for Our Players (U9 / U10)

- Protect sleep the two nights before.
- Familiar meals, a proper breakfast.
- Water before thirst.
- Limit running around between games.
- Quiet activities and a dry change of clothes for downtime.
- Keep the ride home short on analysis.
- Let the coaches coach.

12. Packing Checklist

Player gear

- ☐ Both kits (white and blue)
- ☐ Cleats and shin guards
- ☐ Two spare pairs of socks
- ☐ Warm-up layer
- ☐ Dry clothes for after
- ☐ Labeled water bottle
- ☐ Personal medication

Parent sideline

- ☐ Camp chairs
- ☐ Blanket or throw
- ☐ Snacks between games
- ☐ Water and a thermos
- ☐ Rain jacket or umbrella
- ☐ Portable charger
- ☐ Wipes and a bag for muddy gear

13. Tournament Rules Parents Need

OFFICIAL TOURNAMENT INFORMATION

Game length (U9/U10)	25-minute halves, 5-minute half-time
Format (U9/U10)	7v7 · maximum roster 12 · up to 3 guest players
Heading	**Not allowed** for U12 and younger — indirect free kick
Offside	One referee for U9–U10, may call obvious offside; no build-out lines
Substitutions	Unlimited, at the referee's discretion at any stoppage
Mercy rule	Match ends at an 8-goal differential
Water breaks	Mandatory at the midpoint of each half when the expected temperature reaches 85 °F
Forfeits	Not ready within 5 minutes forfeits 4-0; be present 30 minutes before kickoff
Championship ties	Straight to penalty kicks

Six-tier tiebreaker (in order)

1. Head-to-head result
2. Net goal differential, max 4 per game
3. Most goals scored, max 6 per game
4. Fewest goals allowed
5. Most shutouts
6. Penalty kicks per FIFA

14. Nearby Family Resources

PENDING CONFIRMATION Added with the hotel block, once we know which complex we play at.

15. Weekend Itinerary

Day before	Travel and check-in if staying over. Early night.
Saturday January 23 – Sunday January 24, 2027	Game times, fields and opponents pending. Expect two matches with a gap for lunch once published.
Final day	Knockout or final rounds, then travel home.

16. Quick Reference — Screenshot This

Sporting Jax Winter Invitational · Saturday January 23 – Sunday January 24, 2027

Jacksonville / St Johns County, FL · 7v7 · 25-minute halves

Host: Sporting Jax Soccer Academy

Stay-to-play — official housing only

17. Next Steps

1. Confirm your player's availability with the team manager.
2. Watch for the hotel block and book inside it.
3. When the schedule publishes, note report times, fields and uniform colour.
4. Week of the event: forecast, layers, departure time confirmed with your coach.

Prepared with Bob Team Manager · Version 1.0 · Updated November 13, 2026 · Sources: sportingjaxacademy.com/WinterInvitational